

An Act

ENROLLED SENATE
BILL NO. 1147

By: Hall, Haste, Pederson, and
Frix of the Senate

and

Caldwell (Trey), Kane,
Bashore, Blancett, Hefner,
Turner, Marti, Dollens,
Wolfley, and Manger of the
House

An Act relating to the Oklahoma Firefighters Pension and Retirement System; amending 11 O.S. 2021, Sections 49-101 and 49-101.2, as amended by Sections 3 and 4, Chapter 232, O.S.L. 2022 (11 O.S. Supp. 2025, Sections 49-101 and 49-101.2), which relate to volunteer firefighter pensions; modifying pension amount; modifying compensation determination; authorizing benefit increase for certain retired members of the Oklahoma Firefighters Pension and Retirement System; amending 62 O.S. 2021, Section 3103, as last amended by Section 2, Chapter 361, O.S.L. 2024 (62 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 3103), which relates to the Oklahoma Pension Legislation Actuarial Analysis Act; modifying certain definition; updating statutory language; providing for codification; and providing effective dates.

SUBJECT: Oklahoma Firefighters Pension and Retirement System

BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

SECTION 1. AMENDATORY 11 O.S. 2021, Section 49-101, as amended by Section 3, Chapter 232, O.S.L. 2022 (11 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 49-101), is amended to read as follows:

Section 49-101. A. All retired volunteer firefighters who qualify for retirement shall be entitled to a monthly pension. The monthly pension of a volunteer firefighter who retires prior to the effective date of this section shall be in the amount retired volunteer firefighters are receiving at the time the volunteer firefighter begins to receive a pension for each year of credited service not to exceed thirty (30) years. Volunteer firefighters who retire on and after the effective date of this section shall receive a monthly pension in the amount of Ten Dollars (\$10.00) for each year of credited service not to exceed thirty (30) years. In determining the number of years of credited service, a fractional year of six (6) months or more shall be counted as one (1) full year and a fractional year of less than six (6) months shall not be counted in such determination. Retired volunteer firefighters of a municipality shall receive a pension ~~of~~ not less than that which retired volunteer firefighters of such municipality were receiving on June 30, 1985.

B. A volunteer firefighter who terminates service after completing ten (10) years of credited service, but less than twenty (20) years of credited service, shall be entitled to receive a vested benefit commencing on the date the firefighter reaches fifty (50) years of age or the date the firefighter would have had twenty (20) years of credited service had the firefighter's service continued uninterrupted, whichever is later. The monthly amount of such retirement benefit shall be the amount being paid to volunteer firefighters at the time the member vests multiplied by the number of years of credited service. Credited service must be established at the time of the volunteer firefighter's termination. If a volunteer firefighter who terminated employment and elected, or was eligible to elect, a vested benefit dies prior to being eligible to receive benefits, the volunteer firefighter's beneficiary, as defined in paragraph 16 of Section 49-100.1 of this title, shall be entitled to the volunteer firefighter's normal monthly retirement benefit on the date the deceased volunteer firefighter would have been eligible to receive the benefit.

SECTION 2. AMENDATORY 11 O.S. 2021, Section 49-101.2, as amended by Section 4, Chapter 232, O.S.L. 2022 (11 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 49-101.2), is amended to read as follows:

Section 49-101.2. Any member serving as an active volunteer firefighter who receives annual compensation from the fire department the firefighter is enrolled in as a member of the Oklahoma Firefighters Pension and Retirement System for services related to firefighting, other than reimbursement of expenses in excess of ~~five and one-half (5 1/2) times the annual pension benefit paid by the System to a retired volunteer firefighter with twenty (20) years credited service~~ Nine Thousand Nine Hundred Thirty-nine Dollars and sixty-nine cents (\$9,939.69), shall be considered a paid firefighter and must meet the physical and agility requirements pursuant to Section 49-116 of this title to continue as an active member of the System. Credited service earned as a paid firefighter pursuant to this section shall not be considered actual experience as a paid firefighter for purposes of meeting the qualifications of a paid fire chief as provided in Section 29-102 of this title. No fire department of a participating municipality shall employ a volunteer firefighter from another fire department to perform services relating to firefighting for any compensation of any kind.

SECTION 3. NEW LAW A new section of law to be codified in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 49-143.8 of Title 11, unless there is created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

A. Except as provided in subsection B of this section, any person receiving benefits from the Oklahoma Firefighters Pension and Retirement System as of June 30, 2026, who continues to receive benefits on or after the effective date of this section, shall receive an increase in benefits as follows:

1. Zero percent (0%) if the person has been retired for less than ten (10) years as of June 30, 2026;
2. Three percent (3%) if the person has been retired for at least ten (10) years but less than twenty (20) years as of June 30, 2026; and
3. Six percent (6%) if the person has been retired for twenty (20) years or more as of June 30, 2026.

B. Any increase in benefits a person is eligible to receive pursuant to repealed Section 49-136 of Title 11 of the Oklahoma

Statutes after June 30, 2020, shall be used to offset the increase in benefits provided in subsection A of this section.

SECTION 4. AMENDATORY 62 O.S. 2021, Section 3103, as last amended by Section 2, Chapter 361, O.S.L. 2024 (62 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 3103), is amended to read as follows:

Section 3103. As used in the Oklahoma Pension Legislation Actuarial Analysis Act:

1. "Amendment" means any amendment, including a substitute bill, made to a retirement bill by any committee of the House of Representatives or Senate, any conference committee of the House or Senate or by the House or Senate;

2. "RB number" means that number preceded by the letters "RB" assigned to a retirement bill by the respective staffs of the ~~Oklahoma State~~ Senate and the ~~Oklahoma~~ House of Representatives when the respective staff office prepares a retirement bill for a member of the Legislature;

3. "Legislative Actuary" means the firm or entity that enters into a contract with the Legislative Service Bureau pursuant to Section 452.15 of Title 74 of the Oklahoma Statutes to provide the actuarial services and other duties provided for in the Oklahoma Pension Legislation Actuarial Analysis Act;

4. "Nonfiscal amendment" means an amendment to a retirement bill having a fiscal impact, which amendment does not change any factor of an actuarial investigation specified in subsection A of Section 3109 of this title;

5. "Nonfiscal retirement bill" means a retirement bill:

- a. which does not affect the cost or funding factors of a retirement system,
- b. which affects such factors only in a manner which does not:
 - (1) grant a benefit increase under the retirement system affected by the bill,

- (2) create an actuarial accrued liability for or increase the actuarial accrued liability of the retirement system affected by the bill, or
 - (3) increase the normal cost of the retirement system affected by the bill,
- c. which authorizes the purchase by an active member of the retirement system, at the actuarial cost for the purchase as computed pursuant to the statute in effect on the effective date of the measure allowing such purchase, of years of service for purposes of reaching a normal retirement date in the applicable retirement system, but which cannot be used in order to compute the number of years of service for purposes of computing the retirement benefit for the member,
- d. which provides for the computation of a service-connected disability retirement benefit for members of the Oklahoma Law Enforcement Retirement System pursuant to Section 2-305 of Title 47 of the Oklahoma Statutes if the members were unable to complete twenty (20) years of service as a result of the disability,
- e. which requires membership in the defined benefit plan authorized by Section 901 et seq. of Title 74 of the Oklahoma Statutes for persons whose first elected or appointed service occurs on or after November 1, 2018, if such persons had any prior service in the Oklahoma Public Employees Retirement System prior to November 1, 2015,
- f. which provides for a one-time increase in retirement benefits if the increase in retirement benefits is not a permanent increase in the gross annual retirement benefit payable to a member or beneficiary, occurs only once pursuant to a single statutory authorization and does not exceed:
 - (1) the lesser of two percent (2%) of the gross annual retirement benefit of the member or One

Thousand Dollars (\$1,000.00) and requires that the benefit may only be provided if the funded ratio of the affected retirement system would not be less than sixty percent (60%) but not greater than eighty percent (80%) after the benefit increase is paid,

- (2) the lesser of two percent (2%) of the gross annual retirement benefit of the member or One Thousand Two Hundred Dollars (\$1,200.00) and requires that the benefit may only be provided if the funded ratio of the affected retirement system would be greater than eighty percent (80%) but not greater than one hundred percent (100%) after the benefit increase is paid,
- (3) the lesser of two percent (2%) of the gross annual retirement benefit of the member or One Thousand Four Hundred Dollars (\$1,400.00) and requires that the benefit may only be provided if the funded ratio of the affected retirement system would be greater than one hundred percent (100%) after the benefit increase is paid, or
- (4) the greater of two percent (2%) of the gross annual retirement benefit of the volunteer firefighter or One Hundred Dollars (\$100.00) for persons who retired from the Oklahoma Firefighters Pension and Retirement System as volunteer firefighters and who did not retire from the Oklahoma Firefighters Pension and Retirement System as a paid firefighter.

As used in this subparagraph, "funded ratio" means the figure derived by dividing the actuarial value of assets of the applicable retirement system by the actuarial accrued liability of the applicable retirement system,

- g. which modifies the disability pension standard for police officers who are members of the Oklahoma Police

Pension and Retirement System as provided by Section 50-115 of Title 11 of the Oklahoma Statutes,

h. which provides a cost-of-living benefit increase pursuant to the provisions of:

(1) Section 49-143.7 of Title 11 of the Oklahoma Statutes,

(2) Section 3 of this act,

(3) Section 50-136.9 of Title 11 of the Oklahoma Statutes,

~~(3)~~ (4) Section 1104K of Title 20 of the Oklahoma Statutes,

~~(4)~~ (5) Section 2-305.12 of Title 47 of the Oklahoma Statutes,

~~(5)~~ (6) Section 17-116.22 of Title 70 of the Oklahoma Statutes,

~~(6)~~ (7) Section 930.11 of Title 74 of the Oklahoma Statutes,

i. which modifies the computation of the line-of-duty disability benefit pursuant to the provisions of this section and Sections 50-101 and 50-115 of Title 11 of the Oklahoma Statutes, ~~or~~

j. which authorizes membership in the Oklahoma Law Enforcement Retirement System for active commissioned or CLEET-certified agents of the Office of the Attorney General or the Military Department of the State of Oklahoma pursuant to Sections 3 and 4 of this act, or

k. which provides for a benefits increase for volunteer firefighters pursuant to Sections 49-101 and 49-101.2 of Title 11 of the Oklahoma Statutes.

A nonfiscal retirement bill shall include any retirement bill that has as its sole purpose the appropriation or distribution or redistribution of monies in some manner to a retirement system for purposes of reducing the unfunded liability of such system or the earmarking of a portion of the revenue from a tax to a retirement system or increasing the percentage of the revenue earmarked from a tax to a retirement system;

6. "Reduction-in-cost amendment" means an amendment to a retirement bill having a fiscal impact which reduces the cost of the bill as such cost is determined by the actuarial investigation for the bill prepared pursuant to Section 3109 of this title;

7. "Retirement bill" means any bill or joint resolution introduced or any bill or joint resolution amended by a member of the Legislature which creates or amends any law directly affecting a retirement system. A retirement bill shall not mean a bill or resolution that impacts the revenue of any state tax in which a portion of the revenue generated from such tax is earmarked for the benefit of a retirement system;

8. "Retirement bill having a fiscal impact" means any retirement bill creating or establishing a retirement system and any other retirement bill other than a nonfiscal retirement bill; and

9. "Retirement system" means the Teachers' Retirement System of Oklahoma, the Oklahoma Public Employees Retirement System, the Uniform Retirement System for Justices and Judges, the Oklahoma Firefighters Pension and Retirement System, the Oklahoma Police Pension and Retirement System, the Oklahoma Law Enforcement Retirement System, or a retirement system established after January 1, 2006.

SECTION 5. Section 4 of this act shall become effective October 1, 2026.

SECTION 6. Sections 1, 2, and 3 of this act shall become effective November 1, 2026.

Passed the Senate the 14th day of April, 2026.

Presiding Officer of the Senate

Passed the House of Representatives the 16th day of April, 2026.

Presiding Officer of the House
of Representatives

OFFICE OF THE GOVERNOR

Received by the Office of the Governor this _____

day of _____, 20_____, at _____ o'clock _____ M.

By: _____

Approved by the Governor of the State of Oklahoma this _____

day of _____, 20_____, at _____ o'clock _____ M.

Governor of the State of Oklahoma

OFFICE OF THE SECRETARY OF STATE

Received by the Office of the Secretary of State this _____

day of _____, 20_____, at _____ o'clock _____ M.

By: _____